

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

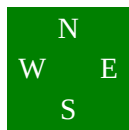
Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K 7 4
♥ 8 7 2
♦ K 8 2
♣ J 10 7 5

♠ Q J 10
♥ A 3
♦ 10 9 5 4
♣ A K 3 2



♠ 9 6 5 3
♥ J 10 9 6 4
♦ A 6
♣ 9 8

♠ A 8 2
♥ K Q 5
♦ Q J 7 3
♣ Q 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

While this is a possible Plan, there is a far better one.

Rather than chance the ♠ finesse, you should immediately start establishing your ♦s. This has the advantage of not giving the defense any **NEW** winners - they were always going to get their two high ♦s. So win the ♥A and play the ♦10. Somebody will take this and probably continue with a ♥. Take the ♥Q and play the ♦Q. Somebody will take this and probably continue with a ♥. Take the ♥K and then the rest of your winners. Maybe the ♣s will split 3-3 and give you an overtrick. And if you have assured the contract you MIGHT even try the ♠ finesse.

If you had taken an early ♠ finesse you would have gone down.

West would have won and played a ♥, removing your second stopper. When ♣s did not split 3-3 you would have been forced to try a ♦. West would win his ♦K and drive out the last ♥ stopper. Then East would be able to take the ♦A plus his established ♥s.

You have three reasonable choices. You could bid 2♣, you could jump to 3♦, or you could jump to 2NT.

While all are reasonable, the jump to 2NT stands out as the most constructive by far. Partner bids 3NT and you pass.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥J.

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Winner count: ♠ 1 : ♥ 3 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 3 : Total = 7

If East has the ♠K then a finesse will gain you the two winners you need. However, if West has the ♠K then the finesse will gain you just one winner and you will be hoping for a 3-3 ♣ split for the other.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 7
 ♥ A 8 3
 ♦ 9 5 2
 ♣ Q 8 7 4 3

♠ 9 4

♥ 7 6 5 2

♦ Q 7 6 4

♣ A J 9



♠ A K 6 2
 ♥ K Q J 10 9
 ♦ A J
 ♣ 6 5

♠ Q J 10 5 3

♥ 4

♦ K 10 8 3

♣ K 10 2

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
2♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by East

out but cannot over-ruff. Return to your hand with the ♦ A and ruff your last ♠ with dummy's ♥ A. Return to your hand with a trump. You will lose three minor suit cards and nothing else.

Some would go down on this hand when they ruffed the first ♠ with dummy's ♥ 3 and North over-ruffed. It is pretty clear that you should ruff with one of the higher cards, but sometimes the thought comes too late.

With 19 points and a 5-card ♥ suit you open 1♥.

Partner raises you to 2♥.

Partner's bid shows 6-10 points. If he has 6 it might be close, but otherwise you should have a game. You bid 4♥.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♠ Q.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♠ Q.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 2 : Total = 5

The three minor suit losers cannot be avoided, but the two ♠ losers can be ruffed in dummy. A small amount of caution is in order. Win the ♠ K and play the ♠ A. Ruff a ♠ with dummy's ♥ 8. North shows the ♠ A. Ruff a ♠ with dummy's ♥ A. Return to your hand with a trump. You will lose three minor suit cards and nothing else.